04 REAL ESTATE DEVELOPMENT

Real estate development

An overview of the decisions, delivery dependencies, and risks across a development lifecycle.

THE INVESTMENT LENS

Real estate development brings land, planning, financing, design, procurement, construction, and eventual operation or sale into a single, interdependent process. Project feasibility can change materially as scope, approvals, delivery costs, financing conditions, and market demand evolve. A concept, planning application, or promotional estimate is not a completed or income-producing asset.

Considerations

- Review land acquisition, title, permitted use, planning status, design, buildability, utilities, and access as one connected proposition.
- Examine the independent basis for development costs, contingencies, construction schedule, procurement, and operating assumptions.
- Stress-test financing, interest, refinancing needs, currency exposure, lease-up, sales pace, and practical exit options.
- Clarify project governance, developer experience, contractor obligations, procurement controls, reporting, and decision rights.

Risks to understand

- Planning, environmental, building-control, infrastructure, and other approvals can change, take longer, or not be granted.
- Construction costs, contractor performance, financing, labor or materials availability, and delivery timelines may vary.
- Market rents, occupancy, sales prices, and buyer or tenant demand can be materially different from assumptions.
- Projects can require additional capital, encounter disputes, or become delayed, incomplete, unoccupied, or difficult to sell.

BEFORE CONSIDERING AN OPPORTUNITY

Start with the questions that matter.

01 What approvals are final and effective, what conditions remain, and has independent counsel reviewed site control and project contracts?

02 Has an independent quantity surveyor or equivalent reviewed the budget, contingency, procurement plan, and completion schedule?

03 What independent evidence supports the leasing, sales, operating-cost, financing, and exit assumptions under less favorable scenarios?

04 What are the funding commitments, capital-call terms, downside remedies, reporting rights, and plans if cost or schedule thresholds are exceeded?

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